Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Fairfield House

85 Ely Road, Cardiff, CF5 2BY

01792311980

www.perthyn.org.uk

The inspection visit took place on 09/09/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Perthyn
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability
Registered places:	6
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Excellent
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Fairfield House is located in Llandaff, Cardiff, and provides residential care and support for adults with a learning disability and/or autistic people who may present with behaviours that challenge services, as well as those with complex needs.

Well-being is excellent because people experience exceptional, life-enhancing outcomes. They are empowered to make meaningful choices, achieve ambitious goals and maximise their independence. As a result, they enjoy improved well-being, strong relationships, greater community inclusion and enriched, self-directed lives.

Care and support is good because people receive safe, personalised support which helps them stay healthy, maintain their independence and achieve what matters to them. Care is regularly reviewed and adapted to meet changing needs, and effective health, safeguarding, medication and

safety arrangements help people to live well and achieve positive outcomes

The environment is good because people benefit from an environment which supports their safety, comfort and well-being. The home offers a variety of facilities enabling people to spend their time in ways which are meaningful to them, while robust health and safety systems and an established improvement plan provide confidence the environment will continue to be maintained and enhanced.

Leadership and management is good because the service is well run, staff are appropriately trained and supported, and robust quality assurance arrangements drive continuous improvement.

Findings:

Well-being — Excellent

People experience exceptional and life-enhancing well-being outcomes through support expertly tailored to their strengths, aspirations and potential. Care staff have an outstanding understanding of what matters to people and consistently empower them to lead meaningful, ambitious and self-directed lives. As a result, people achieve outcomes which extend far beyond their care and support needs, developing confidence, independence, valued relationships and active roles within their communities.

We found compelling evidence of a highly aspirational and strengths-based culture. People are supported to recognise their abilities, pursue their ambitions and maximise their potential. People, including those with complex needs and experiences of restrictive environments, have overcome barriers and achieved outcomes previously unattainable. This has led to transformative and sustained improvements in well-being, confidence and quality of life. Professionals highly commend the provider's approach, noting *"The organisation supports individuals to develop their potential by ensuring any outcomes are service user specific."*

People are at the centre of decision-making, with care staff demonstrating an exceptional understanding of individual communication needs, preferences and wishes. Highly personalised communication approaches enable people to express their views, make informed choices and exercise maximum control and independence in their daily lives. Through tailored communication tools and support, people have a strong voice in decisions affecting them.

We saw excellent progress towards meaningful personal goals. One person, following a lengthy hospital stay, rebuilt their confidence and independence through positive risk-taking and now accesses community facilities independently. Professionals report a significant improvement in their confidence, self-esteem and quality of life, while reviews evidence increased confidence, stronger communication and greater participation in everyday life.

People tell us they feel safe. One person said "*The staff treat me as they should. I feel safe here*". Keeping people safe is central to the service and is reflected in staff's everyday practice Knowledgeable staff, accessible information, advocacy and personalised communication methods ensure people can confidently raise concerns.

People are supported to build and sustain meaningful relationships, strengthen community connections and live enriched, fulfilling lives. Care staff promote inclusion, belonging and opportunity, enabling people to overcome barriers, grow in confidence and participate fully in activities which reflect their interests and aspirations. Family relationships are actively nurtured, helping people maintain important connections and enjoy meaningful time with loved ones,

resulting in enhanced well-being, stronger support networks and a greater sense of belonging.

The provider is working towards the Welsh Active Offer.

Care & Support — Good

People receive good quality care and support. Detailed assessments help ensure care staff have a good understanding of people's strengths, health needs, communication styles, risks and desired outcomes before support is provided. The provider works closely with families, advocates and healthcare professionals to ensure care reflects what is important to each person and promotes positive outcomes.

People are involved in planning and reviewing their care wherever possible. Personal plans provide care staff with clear guidance about how people wish to be supported, including their routines, preferences, communication needs and goals. Reviews help ensure support remains relevant as needs change. We found examples of care being adapted in response to changes in people's circumstances and achievements.

People benefit from support which encourages them to develop skills, increase independence and participate in daily life. During our inspection, we observed people taking part in household activities, preparing food and making choices about how they spent their time. Care staff were patient, encouraging and focused on promoting independence, rather than completing tasks for people. Interactions were warm, respectful and person-centred, helping people feel valued and involved.

People receive support which promotes their health and well-being through effective partnership working with healthcare professionals. These include GPs, psychiatrists, psychologists and specialist services. This ensures people receive timely advice, treatment and support. We saw evidence of positive health outcomes, including a significant reduction in one person's seizure activity through specialist guidance, regular reviews and staff training.

People are protected through effective safeguarding arrangements. Care staff demonstrate a good understanding of their safeguarding responsibilities and were able to explain how they would respond to concerns. Risk assessments are detailed and regularly reviewed, helping people remain safe whilst promoting independence and choice.

People receive their medication safely from trained and competent care staff. Robust medication systems support safe administration, storage and recording practices. Care staff complete medication training, competency assessments and refresher training to ensure they remain knowledgeable and skilled. Where people have specialist health needs, such as epilepsy, additional training and guidance are provided to ensure medication is administered safely and effectively. Medication arrangements are reviewed regularly to help ensure they continue to meet people's needs.

People are protected from the risk of infection through effective infection prevention and control arrangements. Staff receive infection control training and were observed using appropriate personal protective equipment. Cleaning schedules, environmental checks and health and safety monitoring help maintain a safe environment.

Environment — Good

People live in a spacious and welcoming home which provides a comfortable environment and a range of facilities to support their well-being, independence and quality of life. Bedrooms are personalised to reflect people's tastes and preferences, helping them to feel at home and maintain their individuality. People share communal bathrooms which are modern and adapted to meet individual needs. The home offers several communal areas which provide people with choice about how they spend their time. A large lounge provides a comfortable setting where people can relax, watch television and spend time together. There is also a smaller lounge equipped with games, craft materials and other resources to support people's interests and encourage meaningful activities. A bright conservatory-dining area overlooks the garden and provides an attractive space for people to enjoy meals and social interaction with others. The layout of the home also includes quieter areas where people can spend time alone or meet with visitors and professionals in private.

People have access to a secure and enclosed garden which offers opportunities to spend time outdoors in a safe environment. The garden includes lawned areas, plants and seating areas, enabling people to relax, socialise and enjoy outdoor activities throughout the year.

During the inspection we identified some areas of the environment which would benefit from improvement, including wear and tear to décor, flooring and furnishings, together with a small number of maintenance issues. The provider had already identified these areas and was able to demonstrate a comprehensive programme of refurbishment and improvement works. We saw evidence of ongoing investment in the home, including plans for redecoration and upgrades designed to further enhance the quality of the living environment. Management demonstrates a proactive approach to identifying priorities, reducing risks and monitoring progress. We are assured improvements are being progressed in a planned and timely way.

Arrangements to support health and safety are well established. Access to the home is controlled through secure entrance doors and visitor sign-in procedures, helping to promote people's safety and security.

The provider undertakes regular monitoring and testing of the environment, including fire safety checks, fire drills, emergency lighting tests, legionella monitoring, water temperature checks, electrical testing and gas safety inspections. Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans (PEEPs) are available for individuals, and first aid equipment is subject to regular checks. These arrangements help ensure people live in an environment where risks are identified and managed appropriately.

Leadership & Management — Good

People benefit from a well organised, effectively managed service which focuses on achieving positive outcomes. Care staff, professionals and managers consistently describe a service which is person-centred, supportive and committed to continuous improvement.

People are supported by leaders who know them well and maintain effective oversight of their care and support needs. Managers regularly review people's health, risks, goals and future plans, working with professionals and responding to changing needs to help ensure positive outcomes. Professionals speak positively about the leadership of the service. One professional described the Registered Manager as *"a very proactive, hands on manager who understands the needs of the people supported."*

Care staff tell us they feel well supported by managers and have access to regular supervision, appraisals, team meetings and informal support. One member of staff said, *"The support from management is very good,"* while another told us, *"Management are great and really supportive."* Care staff describe opportunities to progress within the organisation, with one deputy manager explaining they had progressed from a support worker role into management.

People are supported by staff with the skills, knowledge and training needed to meet their needs. Training is tailored to the people living at the service, including autism, epilepsy, positive behaviour support, safeguarding, trauma-informed practice and medication management. Care staff speak positively about the training provided, with one member of staff saying, *"The training is very good here, trauma training has helped me gain a better understanding of people's experiences and needs."*

People, families, staff and professionals have opportunities to share their views about the service. Feedback is gathered through reviews, meetings, surveys and visits from senior leaders. Information is provided in accessible formats to help people participate as fully as possible.

Safe recruitment processes help ensure suitable staff are employed. We found evidence of appropriate pre-employment checks, including references, Disclosure and Barring Service checks, right to work documentation and verification of qualifications.

The provider has effective systems in place to monitor the quality of the service and identify areas for improvement. These include visits by the Responsible Individual, quality assurance audits, health and safety checks, medication audits and reviews of the quality of care provided. Where issues are identified, action plans are developed to address them and improve outcomes for people. We found evidence learning from audits is used to strengthen practice and support service

improvements.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Welsh Government © Crown copyright 2026.
You may use and re-use the information featured in this publication (not including logos) free of charge in any format or medium, under the terms of the Open Government License. You can view the Open Government License, on the National Archives website or you can write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gov.uk
You must reproduce our material accurately and not use it in a misleading context.